

Beach Shack Fine Casual

Where the ocean meets the plate — executed with precision.

44	\$44	24%	\$26K
SEATS	AVG SPEND	FOOD COST	EST. MONTHLY NET

// WHAT A MICHELIN-TRAINED CHEF SEES IN SEAFOOD FINE CASUAL

Seafood cookery has the narrowest margin for error of any protein category. A fish overcooked by 90 seconds is a different product. The window between raw and perfect on a piece of fresh branzino is measured in minutes — sometimes seconds. This is why seafood restaurants fail at higher rates than other categories: the technique requirement is non-negotiable and the sourcing dependency is real. Fresh fish within 48 hours is not a preference. It is the product. The beach shack fine casual format works because it resolves this tension: a limited menu built around the best of what came in that morning, executed at high technique, served in a relaxed environment.

// WHAT THIS GUIDE DOES

Coastal US markets are the fastest-growing segment for premium casual dining. The lobster roll at \$28.99 with a 23.5% food cost is not expensive. It is correctly priced for what it is.

This guide builds the operation that earns that price point.

Entrées

Raw Oysters on the Half Shell

1. Raw Oysters on the Half Shell

Ticket Time: 4 min | Food Cost: 22% | Allergens: Molluscs

- 1 Source oysters from certified supplier — must be consumed within 48 hours of harvest date stamped on tag.
- 2 Store flat-side up on ice at **34–38°F**. Never submerge in fresh water.
- 3 Shuck to order using a thick towel grip. Insert knife at hinge, twist, slide flat along top shell. Clean lip of any shell fragments.
- 4 Arrange 6 per service on crushed ice plate. Serve with mignonette, lemon wedge, and cocktail sauce.

📌 Chef's Note: Always verify harvest tags before service. Any oyster that smells of ammonia or has a dry, retracted body — discard immediately. No exceptions.

2. Ceviche — Citrus Cured Fish

Ticket Time: 6 min (cure pre-done) | Food Cost: 19% | Allergens: Fish

- 1 Begin cure at 07:00 — 4-hour minimum. Dice fresh white fish (sea bass or similar) to ½-inch cubes.
- 2 Combine with lime juice, lemon juice, finely diced red onion, serrano chile, salt. Cover and refrigerate.
- 3 At service: fold in diced avocado, cilantro, diced tomato. Taste and adjust salt/acid.
- 4 Serve chilled in a shallow bowl with plantain chips or tostadas on the side.

📌 Chef's Note: Cure past 6 hours and fish texture becomes chalky. Pre-portion cure batches to match projected covers. Do not cure overnight.

3. Fish Tacos — Baja Style

Ticket Time: 8 min | Food Cost: 20% | Allergens: Fish, Gluten

- 1 Cut fresh cod or mahi-mahi into 2 oz strips. Season with cumin, smoked paprika, salt, lime zest.
- 2 Dredge in seasoned flour, dip in cold sparkling water batter, fry at **375°F** for 3–4 min until golden.
- 3 Warm corn tortillas on flat-top 30 seconds each side. Build: shredded cabbage, chipotle crema, pico de gallo, fish, fresh cilantro, lime.
- 4 Serve 3 tacos per order with lime wedge and small cup of salsa verde.

Entrées (continued)

4. Grilled Corn — Elote Style

Ticket Time: 5 min | Food Cost: 11% | Allergens: Dairy

- 1 Grill corn on the cob over open flame or char-grill, turning every 90 seconds until charred in patches — approx 6 min total. Pre-grill in batch, finish to order.
- 2 Remove from heat. Brush generously with mayo-lime blend.
- 3 Roll in crumbled cotija cheese. Dust with chili powder, smoked paprika, and fine salt.
- 4 Finish with squeeze of fresh lime and chopped cilantro. Serve on corn holders.

🚩 Lowest food cost on the menu at 11%. This is your margin anchor. Push as a pair with oysters for table share.

5. Clam Chowder — House

Ticket Time: 6 min (base pre-made) | Food Cost: 18% | Allergens: Molluscs, Dairy, Gluten

- 1 Base made from 08:00 — clam juice, onion, celery, potatoes, thyme, white wine, cream, clam meat. Simmer 30 min, rest to develop.
- 2 At service: ladle 10 oz into sauce pot, heat gently. Do not boil — cream will break.
- 3 Verify potato is fork-tender. Adjust seasoning with white pepper and sea salt.
- 4 Serve in warm bowl with oyster crackers, chives, and a drizzle of quality olive oil.

6. Shrimp Cocktail

Ticket Time: 4 min | Food Cost: 21% | Allergens: Crustaceans

- 1 Poach U16/20 shrimp in court bouillon — celery, lemon, bay leaf, peppercorns — at 185°F for 3–4 min. Do not boil.
- 2 Ice-shock immediately. Peel and devein, leaving tail on.
- 3 Serve 5 per order draped over glass ramekin with house cocktail sauce (horseradish-forward) and lemon cheeks.

🚩 Pre-poach in batches during prep window. Store on ice. Never serve warm — shrimp cocktail is a cold dish. Temperature is the whole point.

Entrée Overview

Item	Time	Food Cost	Allergens
Raw Oysters on the Half Shell	4 min	22%	Molluscs
Ceviche — Citrus Cured Fish	6 min	19%	Fish
Fish Tacos — Baja Style	8 min	20%	Fish, Gluten
Grilled Corn — Elote Style	5 min	11%	Dairy
Clam Chowder — House	6 min	18%	Molluscs, Dairy, Gluten
Shrimp Cocktail	4 min	21%	Crustaceans

Signature Mains

★ SIGNATURE — Lobster Roll — Connecticut Style

1. Lobster Roll — Connecticut Style ★ SIGNATURE

Price: \$28.99 | Food Cost: 23.5% | Allergens: Crustaceans, Gluten

\$28.99 23.5% ~\$6.81 ~\$22.18

MENU PRICEFOOD COST RAW COST CONTRIBUTION

- 1 Steam live lobster at **212°F** for 12 min per 1.25 lb. Shock in ice water. Extract tail and claw meat cleanly — no cartilage.
- 2 Cut into generous chunks. Keep cold until service. Do not shred — Connecticut style is whole pieces.
- 3 Butter-poach to order: melt unsalted butter in pan at **160°F** (beurre monté), add lobster, warm gently 2–3 min. Season with sea salt and chive.
- 4 Toast split-top brioche bun in clarified butter until golden. Fill generously. No mayo — this is Connecticut, not Maine.
- 5 Serve with kettle chips and a lemon wedge. Keep it simple. The lobster is the star.

► The \$28.99 price is not a luxury markup — it is correct margin on a real product. Butter quality, brioche quality, and lobster freshness are all visible to the guest. Do not cut corners on any of the three.

2. Grilled Whole Fish ★ SIGNATURE

Ticket Time: 14 min | Food Cost: 23% | Allergens: Fish

- 1 Use branzino, dorade, or catch of the day (1–1.5 lb whole fish, scaled and gutted). Score skin 3x each side at 45°.
- 2 Season cavity with lemon slices, thyme, garlic, olive oil, salt. Exterior: olive oil, coarse sea salt, cracked pepper.
- 3 Grill skin-side down on oiled grate at **450°F** for 7 min. Do not move. Flip carefully, grill 5–6 min. Internal temp **140°F**.
- 4 Rest 2 min. Serve on platter with grilled lemon, herb oil, and seasonal roasted vegetables.

► This is a tableside moment. Train servers to describe the fish at delivery — species, where it came from, how long ago it was caught. That story is part of the product.

7. Scallops & Brown Butter ★ SIGNATURE

Ticket Time: 10 min | Food Cost: 24% | Allergens: Molluscs, Dairy

- 1 Dry-pack U10 sea scallops. Pat completely dry with paper towels — moisture is the enemy of sear. Season with salt only. Do not pepper until after sear.
- 2 Heat stainless or cast iron pan until smoking. Add neutral oil. Scallops go flat-side down — do not move for 2.5 min. Look for golden crust creeping up the side.
- 3 Flip once. Add unsalted butter, baste for 90 seconds until brown and nutty. Internal **125°F**.
- 4 Plate on cauliflower purée or pea purée. Drizzle brown butter, microgreens, sea salt finish.

Mains (continued)

3. Pan-Seared Salmon

Ticket Time: 10 min | Food Cost: 22% | Allergens: Fish

- 1 6 oz skin-on Atlantic salmon fillet. Bring to room temp 20 min before service. Score skin lightly to prevent curling.
- 2 Heat oil in pan until shimmering. Place skin-down, press lightly for first 10 seconds. Cook skin-side 6 min on medium-high — do not flip early.
- 3 Flip, add butter and thyme, baste 2 min. Rest 2 min. Internal **130°F** for medium.
- 4 Serve skin-up on herb lemon cream sauce with wilted spinach and roasted fingerling potatoes.

4. Prawn Linguine

Ticket Time: 12 min | Food Cost: 20% | Allergens: Crustaceans, Gluten

- 1 Cook linguine al dente in salted water. Reserve 4 oz pasta water before draining.
- 2 Sauté garlic and chili flakes in olive oil. Add peeled prawns, cook 2 min per side.
- 3 Deglaze with white wine, reduce 1 min. Add pasta water, toss linguine in pan to emulsify sauce.
- 4 Finish with lemon zest, parsley, drizzle of EVOO. Season. Serve with crusty bread.

5. Shrimp Po'boy

Ticket Time: 8 min | Food Cost: 19% | Allergens: Crustaceans, Gluten

- 1 Season shrimp with Cajun spice, dredge in seasoned cornmeal flour, fry at **375°F** until golden — 2.5 min.
- 2 Toast hoagie roll. Spread remoulade (mayo, hot sauce, capers, lemon, pickles). Add shredded lettuce, tomato slices.
- 3 Load fried shrimp generously, top with pickled jalapeño. Serve with seasoned fries or slaw.

6. Grilled Swordfish Steak

Ticket Time: 12 min | Food Cost: 24% | Allergens: Fish

- 1 8 oz swordfish steak, 1-inch thick. Marinate 30 min in olive oil, lemon, oregano, garlic.
- 2 Grill at **450°F**: 4 min per side. Quarter-turn at 2 min for crosshatch. Do not overcook — swordfish dries out fast. Target **135°F** internal.
- 3 Rest 3 min. Serve with salsa verde, grilled asparagus, and lemon caper butter.

8. Fish & Chips — House Batter

Ticket Time: 10 min | Food Cost: 18% | Allergens: Fish, Gluten

- 1 Batter: cold sparkling water, plain flour, pinch of turmeric, baking powder, salt. Keep batter cold — lumps are fine.
- 2 6 oz cod fillet, dredge in flour, coat in batter, fry at **375°F** for 5–6 min until deeply golden and puffed.
- 3 Double-fry chips: blanch at **300°F**, drain, finish at **375°F**. Season with malt vinegar salt immediately.
- 4 Serve with house tartar sauce, mushy peas, and malt vinegar on the side.

► Lowest food cost main at 18%. High volume expected. Ensure fryer oil is changed on schedule — degraded oil shows in batter colour and flavour immediately.

Mains (continued)

9. Tuna Poke Bowl

Ticket Time: 6 min | Food Cost: 22% | Allergens: Fish, Soy

- 1 Use sashimi-grade ahi tuna. Cube to ½-inch pieces. Toss in soy sauce, sesame oil, rice vinegar, ginger, scallion, chili flakes. Marinate max 10 min — acid will begin to cure longer than that.
- 2 Build bowl: sushi rice base (seasoned with rice vinegar, sugar, salt), tuna, edamame, cucumber ribbons, avocado fan, pickled radish.
- 3 Drizzle with sriracha mayo. Finish with sesame seeds and nori strips.

10. Crab Cake — Chesapeake Style

Ticket Time: 10 min | Food Cost: 23% | Allergens: Crustaceans, Gluten, Eggs

- 1 Use jumbo lump crabmeat. Binder: egg, mayo, Dijon, Old Bay, parsley, minimal breadcrumb. The crab is the star — do not drown it in filler.
- 2 Form into 4 oz patties. Refrigerate 30 min minimum to set. Pan-sear in butter at medium-high

- for 3 min per side — do not move until crust forms.
- 3 Finish in oven at **375°F** for 4 min. Serve 2 per order on a pool of remoulade with microgreens and lemon.

📌 Never use imitation crab. Chesapeake style means jumbo lump. A crab cake that is mostly filler is not a crab cake — it is a waste of a menu slot.

Mains Overview

Item	Time	Food Cost	Note
Lobster Roll — Connecticut Style	—	23.5%	★ Signature · \$28.99
Grilled Whole Fish	14 min	23%	★ Signature
Pan-Seared Salmon	10 min	22%	—
Prawn Linguine	12 min	20%	—
Shrimp Po'boy	8 min	19%	—
Grilled Swordfish Steak	12 min	24%	—
Scallops & Brown Butter	10 min	24%	★ Signature
Fish & Chips — House Batter	10 min	18%	High Volume
Tuna Poke Bowl	6 min	22%	—
Crab Cake — Chesapeake Style	10 min	23%	—

Desserts

Item	Food Cost	Notes
Lemon Tart	11%	House pastry shell, lemon curd, torched meringue topping
Key Lime Pie	10%	Graham cracker crust, condensed lime filling, whipped cream — pitch hard at service
Coconut Panna Cotta	9%	Sets from 09:00 — coconut cream, gelatin, passion fruit coulis on top
Churros — Cinnamon Sugar	12%	Fried to order, rolled in cinnamon sugar, served with chocolate dipping sauce

10% **9%** **~\$6** **~90%**
LOWEST FC (KEY LIME)BEST MARGIN (PANNA COTTA)AVG DESSERT PRICEGROSS MARGIN

📌 Desserts are pure margin. A table of 4 adding 2 desserts adds ~\$12 at ~10% food cost. Train servers to pitch — not offer, pitch. "The key lime pie and coconut panna cotta are both made in-house this morning. They're worth it."

Drinks

Frozen Margarita

\$12.99 — Tequila blanco, triple sec, fresh lime, salt rim

Aperol Spritz

\$11.99 — Aperol, prosecco, splash soda, orange

Craft IPA

\$7.99 — Local rotating tap. Ask server for today's selection.

Sauvignon Blanc

\$11.99/glass — Crisp, citrus-forward. Pairs with oysters & ceviche.

Fresh Coconut Water

\$5.99 — Served chilled. Pairs with poke bowl and tacos.

Passion Fruit Lemonade

\$5.99 — House-made, fresh squeezed, passion fruit purée

Cold Brew

\$4.99 — 18-hour steep, served over ice. Available all day.

Sparkling Water

\$3.99 — Always suggest when seating. High attach rate.

Service Scripts

These are trained scripts — not suggestions. Delivery should feel natural and unrehearsed, but the structure below is the baseline. Every server knows every script before first solo shift.

SCRIPT 01 — WELCOME + OYSTER PITCH

"Welcome to Beach Shack — I'm [name], I'll be taking care of you today. We're a seafood kitchen — everything came in this morning. While you look over the menu, can I start you off with some oysters? They're on the half shell, freshly shucked — they're one of the best things we do."

SCRIPT 02 – LOBSTER ROLL EXPLANATION (\$28.99, CONNECTICUT STYLE)

"The lobster roll is Connecticut style — that means butter-poached, not mayo-dressed. We steam live lobster in-house, extract the claw and tail meat whole, and warm it in beurre monté right before it hits the bun. It's \$28.99 and it's the thing we're most proud of. A lot of places charge that and give you a roll that's half filler. Ours is just lobster and butter."

SCRIPT 03 – FRESH FISH SOURCING STORY

"Our fish delivery happens at 6 in the morning, every morning. Whatever whole fish came in — that's what the chef builds the specials around. The [today's fish] came in from [local supplier / region] this morning — it was in the water yesterday. That's what we mean when we say fresh."

SCRIPT 04 – DESSERT PITCH (KEY LIME + COCONUT PANNA COTTA)

"Can I tell you about dessert? We make two in-house every morning — the key lime pie has a proper graham cracker crust and condensed lime filling, and the coconut panna cotta has a passion fruit coulis on top that sets overnight. They're both pretty light after a seafood meal. Worth it."

SCRIPT 05 – RETURN VISIT CLOSE

"Come back soon — the menu actually changes based on what comes in. The fish is different week to week, the specials shift with the catch. It's worth seeing what we're running next time you're in."

📌 Scripts are trained, not read. If a server sounds like they're reciting from a card, retrain. The goal is informed confidence — knowing the product well enough to talk about it naturally.

Daily Prep Schedule

This schedule is the operational spine. Deviation from these windows creates service failure. The ceviche cure and panna cotta set are time-dependent — they cannot be rushed.

Time	Task	Owner	Notes
06:00	Fish delivery received & inspected	Head Chef	Check harvest tags, temperature log, smell test. Reject anything suspect.
06:15	Ice down deliveries, portion proteins	Prep Cook	Oysters flat-side up. Fish wrapped and labelled with date/time.
06:30	Stock count vs service estimate	Head Chef	Flag any shortfalls now. No surprises at 11:30.
07:00	Ceviche cure begins (4hr)	Prep Cook	Must be complete by 11:00 for lunch service. Dice fish, combine with citrus. Refrigerate covered.

	minimum)		
08:00	Chowder base starts	Prep Cook	Clam juice, aromatics, potatoes, cream. Simmer 30 min, then rest. Ready for service.
09:00	Panna cotta sets in fridge	Pastry / Prep	Must be set by 18:00 for dinner. 9-hour window. Do not skip.
10:00	Sauces, garnishes, mis en place	All Kitchen	Remoulade, cocktail sauce, chipotle crema, tartar, salsa verde — all fresh daily.
11:00	Line check + temperature verification	Head Chef	All hot-hold above 140°F. All cold-hold below 40°F. Log sheet signed.
11:30	Lunch service opens	All Staff	First cover check at 11:45. Any delay, chef must know immediately.
14:30	Lunch service winds down	—	Begin tracking remaining mise en place for dinner.
15:00	Reset and restock	All Kitchen	Deep clean stations. Restock all sauces. Review remaining fish stock — adjust dinner prep accordingly.
16:30	Dinner prep: re-portion, fresh veg	Prep Cook	Sushi rice for poke, scallops portioned and dried, crab cake patties formed and chilled.
17:30	Dinner line check	Head Chef	Same temp verification as lunch. Log signed. Any item below par — 86 it now, not at 19:00.
18:00	Dinner service opens	All Staff	Peak window 19:00–21:00. Full team on line.
21:30	Begin wind-down prep	Sous Chef	Portion down, no new large cures or preps for tomorrow.
22:00	Close	Closing Team	Temperature log complete. Remaining oysters — discarded if unverified. Fish wrapped and dated. Fryer oil checked.

► The 06:00 fish delivery window is non-negotiable. A late delivery compresses every downstream step. If supplier misses the window 3x in a month, find a new supplier. Your menu depends on that 6am call.

P&L Overview

Based on 44 seats, \$44 average spend, operating 26 days/month with standard service periods. These are working targets — review monthly and adjust labour and food cost lines first when variance occurs.

\$3,520	\$91,520	33%	\$30,201
DAILY REVENUE	MONTHLY REVENUE	NET MARGIN	MONTHLY NET

Line Item	%	Monthly (\$)	Daily (\$)
Total Revenue	100%	\$91,520	\$3,520
Food Cost	24%	\$21,965	\$845

Labour Cost	28%	\$25,626	\$986
Overhead (rent, utilities, supplies)	15%	\$13,728	\$528
NET PROFIT	33%	\$30,201	\$1,162

Key Financial Notes

- 1 Food Cost at 24% is achievable but requires daily fish yield tracking. Any spoilage or over-portioning moves this line fast. Weigh portions, track waste.
- 2 Labour at 28% reflects a tight, skilled team. Seafood execution requires experience — do not cut labour by hiring undertrained staff. The cost shows up in returns and re-fires.
- 3 Overhead at 15% assumes a coastal market lease. If rent exceeds 10% of revenue alone, the model requires renegotiation or volume increase before it works.
- 4 33% net is strong for casual dining. Protect it by controlling the top 3 cost drivers: fish yield, labour scheduling, and drink attach rate.
- 5 Drink attach rate is your highest-margin lever. A table of 4 ordering 2 cocktails and 2 soft drinks adds \$28 at roughly 80% margin. Train for it.

\$44

80/day

1.8x

26 days

AVG SPEND/COVERCOVERS TARGETSEAT TURNS/DAYOP DAYS/MONTH

Allergen Matrix

All front-of-house staff must be able to answer allergen questions confidently without checking a card. This matrix is the training reference. For complex dietary needs, escalate to the kitchen — never guess.

Allergen Reference by Item

ENTRÉES

Raw Oysters on the Half Shell

MOLLUSCS

Ceviche — Citrus Cured Fish

FISH

Clam Chowder — House

MOLLUSCS

DAIRY

GLUTEN

MAINS

Lobster Roll — Connecticut Style

CRUSTACEANS

GLUTEN

DAIRY

Prawn Linguine

CRUSTACEANS

GLUTEN

Scallops & Brown Butter

MOLLUSCS

DAIRY

Crab Cake — Chesapeake Style

CRUSTACEANS

GLUTEN

EGGS

DESSERTS

Key Lime Pie

DAIRY

EGGS

GLUTEN

Food Safety Standards

Item	Safe Temp	Hold Method	Max Hold
Fresh Fish (raw)	<38°F	Ice, wrapped, labelled	48 hours from delivery
Oysters (live)	34–38°F	Flat-side up on ice	Per harvest tag + 48hr
Cooked Proteins	>140°F	Hot hold or serve immediately	4 hours max
Cold Sauces (remoulade, tartar)	<40°F	Refrigerated, covered	3 days
Panna Cotta (set)	<40°F	Refrigerated, covered	48 hours
Ceviche (cured)	<40°F	Covered, labelled	Same day service only
Chowder base	<40°F or >140°F	Reheat per service	2 days
Fry oil	<375°F working	Check colour + smell daily	Change when dark/off-smell

► A seafood kitchen that takes food safety shortcuts will eventually hurt someone. The legal and reputational cost of one incident exceeds the operational cost of doing it right, every time, forever.

Operations Standards

Opening Checklist

- 1 Receive fish delivery — inspect, log harvest tags, ice down within 10 minutes of arrival.
- 2 Start ceviche cure by 07:00. Mark start time on container.
- 3 Fire chowder base by 08:00. Mark production time on container.
- 4 Panna cotta sets by 09:00. Will be ready for dinner service.
- 5 All sauces made fresh: remoulade, cocktail sauce, chipotle crema, tartar, salsa verde.
- 6 Line temp check at 11:00. Sign the temperature log. Both hot and cold verified.
- 7 Brief front-of-house: today's catch, specials, any 86'd items. Takes 5 minutes. Worth every minute.

Closing Checklist

- 1 All remaining oysters: check harvest tags. Any opened or without valid tag — discard. No

1. All remaining fryer oil should be logged every 30 minutes and tagged with harvest tag exceptions.
2. Remaining fish: wrap tightly, label with date and time, store on ice.
3. Sauces: refrigerate with date labels. Discard anything beyond shelf life.
4. Fryer oil: check colour and smell. Log status. Schedule change if needed.
5. Temperature log complete and signed by closing chef.
6. Revenue reconciliation: covers served vs expected, average spend check, any variance noted.
7. Confirm next-day fish order. Adjust based on tomorrow's reservation count and today's remaining stock.

Quality Standards

Standard	Requirement
Fish freshness	Delivered within 48 hours of harvest. Harvest tag required.
Oyster service	Shucked to order. Never pre-shucked. Harvest tag verified before every service.
Lobster roll	Live lobster cooked in-house. No pre-cooked product. Bun toasted to order.
Sauces	All made fresh daily. No pre-packaged condiments except branded hot sauce.
Ticket times	Entrées: ≤8 min. Mains: ≤14 min. Any ticket over time: expeditor alerts chef.
Temperature logging	Twice daily minimum. Every line position. Signed by chef on duty.
Allergen communication	Any allergen query goes to kitchen. Front-of-house does not improvise on allergens.